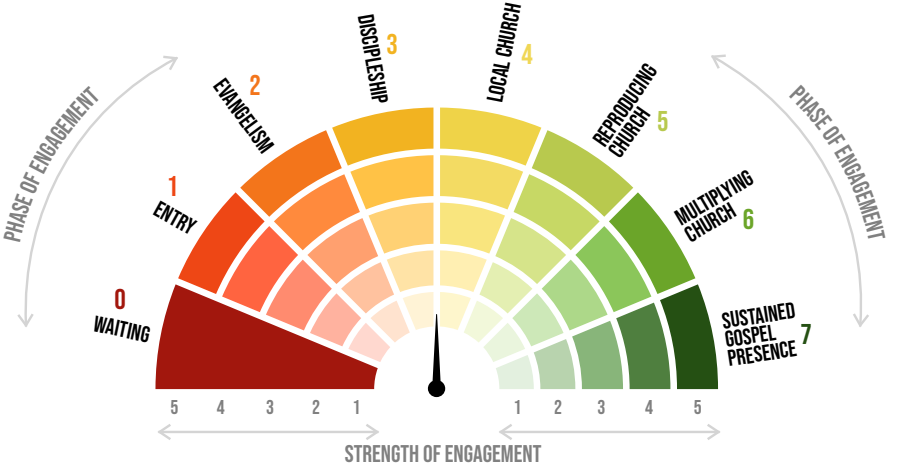
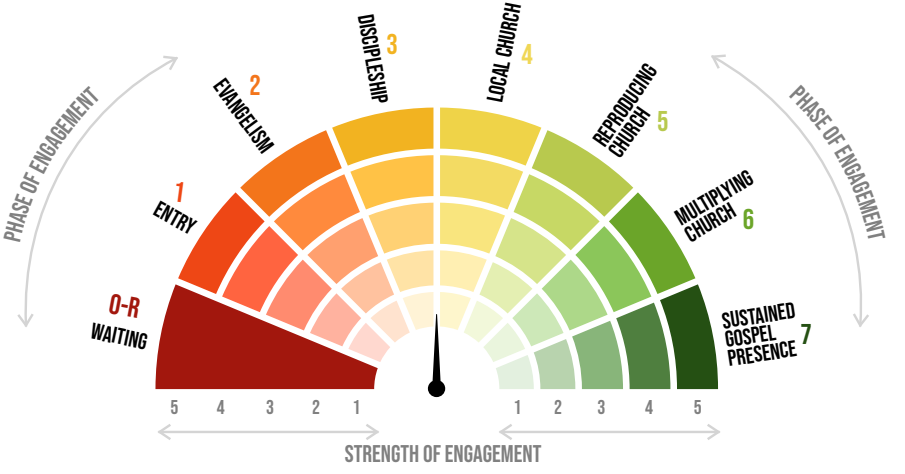
PHASES OF ENGAGEMENT



ENGAGEMENT ACCELERATORS

- PRAYER
- VISION CASTING
- MOBILIZATION/SENDING
- MEETING NEEDS/COMPASSION
- RESEARCH/ CULTURAL INSIGHTS
- TRAINING/EQUIPPING
- SCRIPTURE/RESOURCE ACCESS
- MULTI-NODE ENGAGEMENT
- COLLABORATIVE ENGAGEMENT
- CRITICAL CONTEXTUALIZATION
- MULTIPLYING EFFORTS
- MARKETPLACE INVOLVEMENT

PHASES OF ENGAGEMENT



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PHASES OF ENGAGEMENT

Phases of Engagement (8 phases): Shows the observable progression of gospel activity within a people group, from no known effort to sustained local gospel presence.

PHASE 0: WAITING

PHASE 1: ENTRY

PHASE 2: EVANGELISM

PHASE 3: DISCIPLESHIP

PHASE 4: LOCAL CHURCH

PHASE 5: REPRODUCING CHURCH

PHASE 6: MULTIPLYING CHURCH

PHASE 7: SUSTAINED GOSPEL PRESENCE

Strength of Engagement - Depicts the depth and breadth of current ministry activity within a given phase of engagement.

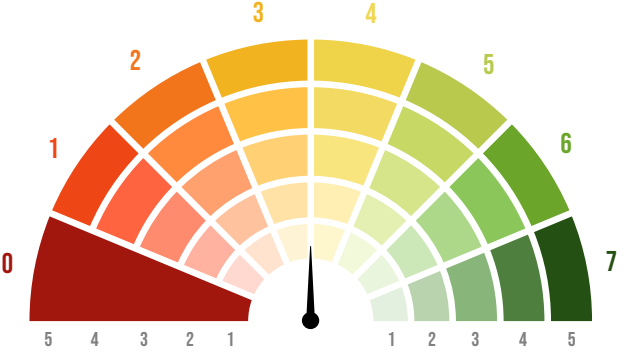
1: UNKNOWN

2: INITIAL

3: GROWING

4: ACTIVE

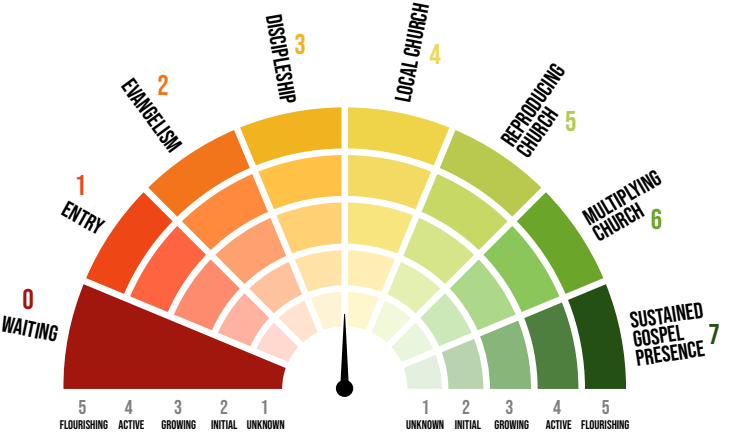
5: FLOURISHING



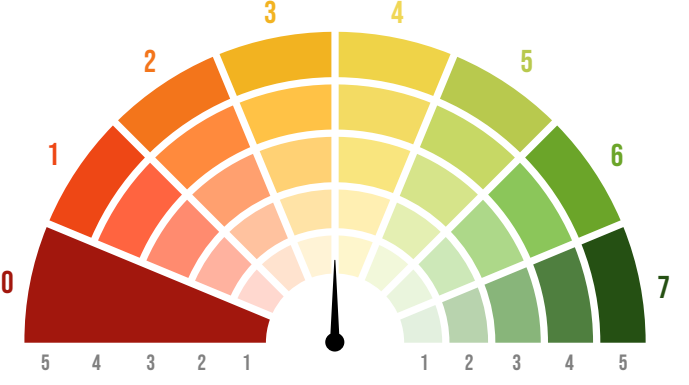
Engagement Accelerators - A self-assessment tool suggesting practices teams can use to identify gaps, choose next steps, and catalyze movement to the next phase.

1. PRAYER
2. VISION CASTING
3. MOBILIZATION/SENDING
4. MEETING NEEDS/COMPASSION
5. RESEARCH/ CULTURAL INSIGHTS
6. TRAINING/EQUIPPING
7. SCRIPTURE/RESOURCE ACCESS
8. MULTI-NODE ENGAGEMENT
9. COLLABORATIVE ENGAGEMENT
10. CRITICAL CONTEXTUALIZATION
11. MULTIPLYING EFFORTS
12. MARKETPLACE INVOLVEMENT

PHASES OF ENGAGEMENT



PHASES OF ENGAGEMENT



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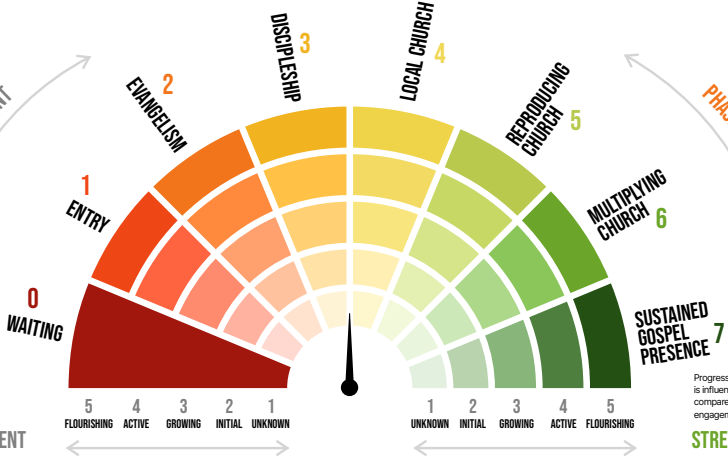
PHASE OF ENGAGEMENT



PHASE OF ENGAGEMENT

Phases of Engagement
Progress or regress between phases is influenced by strength of engagement activities and accelerators.

Strength of Engagement - Depicts the depth and breadth of current ministry activity within a given phase of engagement.

STRENGTH OF ENGAGEMENT

Progress or regress with **Strength of Engagement** is influenced by amount of engagement activity compared to population size, diversity of engagement streams, and accelerators.

STRENGTH OF ENGAGEMENT

ENGAGEMENT ACCELERATORS

Engagement Accelerators - A self-assessment tool suggesting practices teams can use to identify gaps and choose next steps to catalyze movement to the next phase.

- PRAYER
- VISION CASTING
- MOBILIZATION/SENDING
- MEETING NEEDS/COMPASSION
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- MARKETPLACE INVOLVEMENT

ENGAGEMENT ACCELERATORS

Engagement Accelerators highlight key factors that can move a people group toward a stronger, more sustainable gospel presence. They represent 12 strategic domains (e.g., prayer, Scripture access, training, collaboration) that apply across all phases but require different approaches at each phase. Accelerators are not a scorecard, prescription, or rigid method. They are not sequential or listed in order of importance. Instead, Accelerators should be seen as diagnostic and catalytic: they surface gaps, spark ideas, and focus next steps.

PRAYER

Sustained intercession aligned to the people group's realities, seeking God's guidance, protection, and breakthrough. Includes personal, household, and multi-church rhythms.

VISION CASTING

A clear, compelling picture of gospel advance for the people group that aligns teams, churches, and partners. Uses stories and simple data to set direction and sustain momentum.

MOBILIZATION/ SENDING

Identifying, preparing, deploying, and caring for workers (local, near-culture, cross-culture). Includes simple pipelines, coaching, and member care that endure over time.

MEETING NEEDS/ COMPASSION

Tangible expressions of love that dignify communities and open relational doors. Designed to "do no harm," be locally led, and connect naturally to long-term discipleship.

RESEARCH/ CULTURAL INSIGHTS

An ongoing learning posture that maps language, worldview, social networks, migration, and pressure points. Insights are synthesized and fed back into strategy and practice.

TRAINING/ EQUIPPING

Reproducible formation for disciples and leaders in evangelism, disciple-making, leadership, formation, and stewardship. Delivered by practitioners and designed to be passed on.

SCRIPTURE/ RESOURCE ACCESS

Ensuring heart-language access to Scripture and gospel content in appropriate formats (print, audio, app, oral). Prioritizes distribution pathways, local stewardship, and feedback to translation/production.

MULTI-NODE ENGAGEMENT

Coordinated presence across channels and geographies (rural/ urban hubs, strategic cities, diaspora, media, online). Prioritizes and adapts nodes as conditions shift to reach more of the people group.

COLLABORATIVE ENGAGEMENT

Shared prayer, learning, data, and mutual care among churches, agencies, and local believers. Clarifies roles through simple agreements and works together on crises and opportunities.

CRITICAL CONTEXTUALIZATION

Community-discerned application of Scripture that is biblically faithful and culturally meaningful. Regularly reviews forms and practices with diverse voices to guard against drift and syncretism.

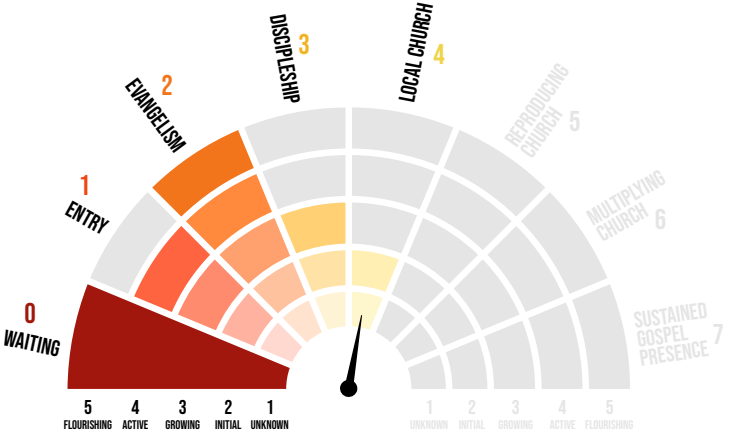
MULTIPLYING EFFORTS

Habits and systems that drive generational growth of disciples, groups, and churches. Emphasizes lay evangelism, identification and development of leaders, and the wise release of authority.

MARKETPLACE INVOLVEMENT

Credible businesses that provide access, witness, and tangible blessing. Operates ethically, favors local ownership, and integrates workplace discipleship where appropriate.

ADVANCED USER VIEW



In this example, the people group is currently in **Phase 4**, but it is only at an **Initial** strength level. This shows that while earlier-stage ministry is flourishing under evangelism and growing in discipleship, the current phase is weaker and needs strengthening. To move forward, energy should be directed toward church planting so Phase 4 becomes more stable and prepared for breakthrough into Phase 5.

PHASE OF ENGAGEMENT
0 WAITING
1 ENTRY
2 EVANGELISM
3 DISCIPLESHIP
4 LOCAL CHURCH
5 REPRODUCING CHURCH
6 MULTIPLYING CHURCH
7 DISTURBED PRESENCE
STRENGTH OF ENGAGEMENT
1 2 3 4 5
PHASE OF ENGAGEMENT

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0 WAITING
1 ENTRY
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3 DISCIPLESHIP
4 LOCAL CHURCH
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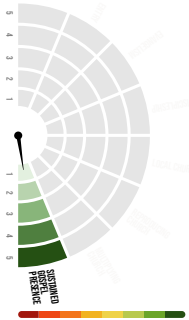
STRENGTH OF ENGAGEMENT
5 4 3 2 1
1 2 3 4 5
PHASE OF ENGAGEMENT

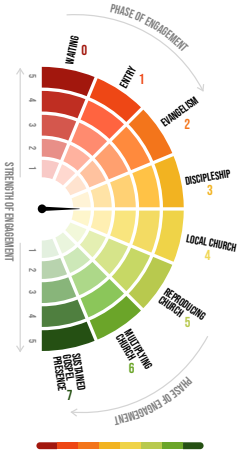
PHASES OF ENGAGEMENT
PHASE OF ENGAGEMENT
0 WAITING
1 ENTRY
2 EVANGELISM
3 DISCIPLESHIP
4 LOCAL CHURCH
5 HOUSEHOLD DISCIPLESHIP
6 MULTIPLYING CHURCH
7 SESTERED GLOBAL PRESENCE
STRENGTH OF ENGAGEMENT
5 4 3 2 1
1 2 3 4 5
ACCELERATORS:
PRAYER, VISION CASTING, MOBILIZATION/SERVING, MEETING NEEDS/COMPASSION, RESEARCH/CULTURAL INSIGHTS,
TRAINING/EQUIPPING, SCRIPTURE/RESOURCE ACCESS, MULTI-MODE EVANGELISM, COLLABORATIVE ENGAGEMENT,
CRITICAL CONTEXTUALIZATION, MULTIPLYING EFFORTS, MARKETPLACE INVOLVEMENT

PHASE 7 - SUSTAINED GOSPEL PRESENCE

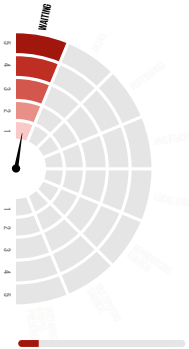


The people group has either: (1) 10% or more following Christ and worshipping in churches, or (2) several multiplying church planting networks led by believers from the people group, who are sending workers to other people groups while continuing to mature at home.

PHASES OF ENGAGEMENT

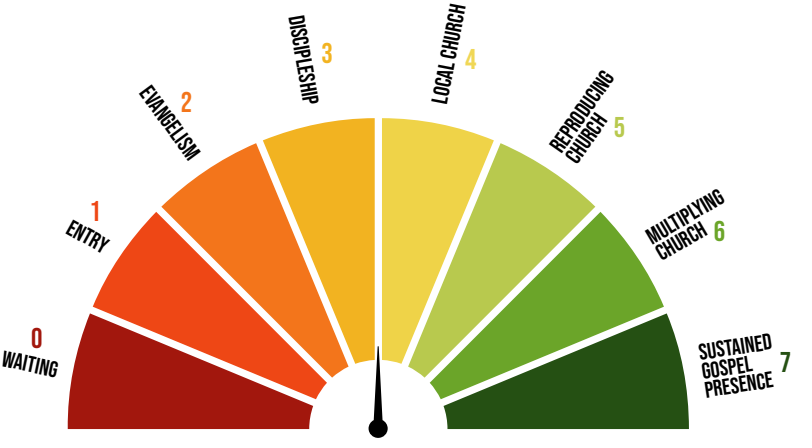


PHASE 0 - ENTRY

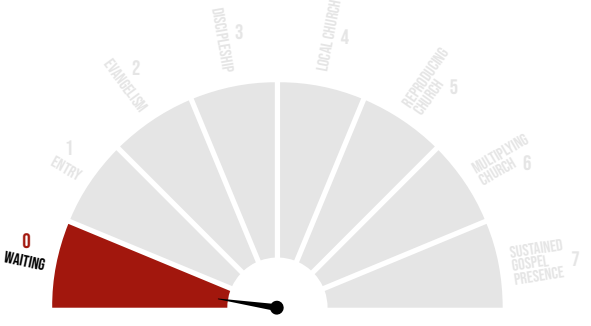


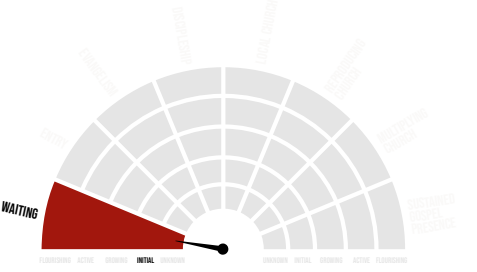
There is no known reported engagement to establish self-sustaining churches, or;
"0-R" - Previous efforts have not resulted in ongoing activity or have not been updated in three years.
Sub-indicator "0-R" marks that a restart is needed.

PHASES OF ENGAGEMENT



PHASE 0 - WAITING





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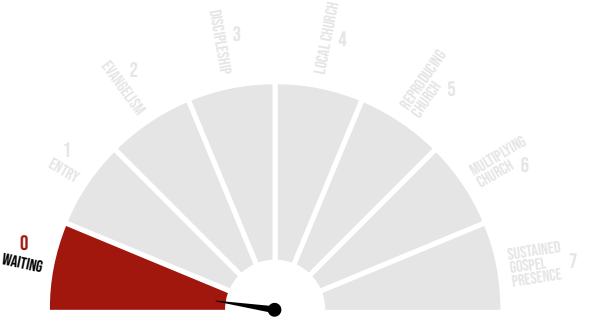

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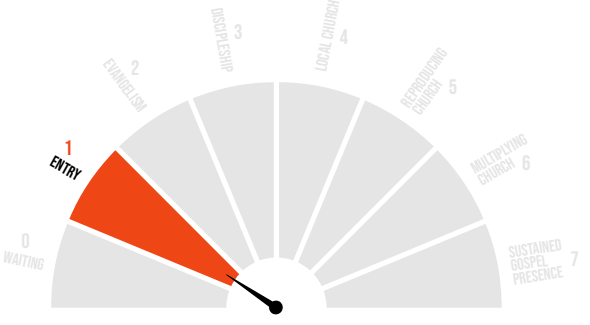

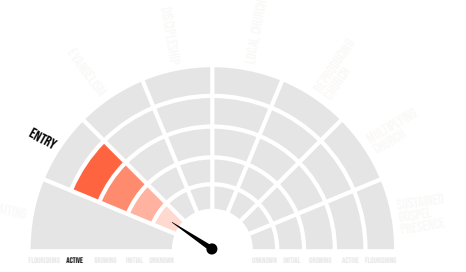

Workers or near-culture believers gain access to the people group and begin laying relational foundations to share Christ and plant churches. The focus is on connecting, learning, and building bridges.

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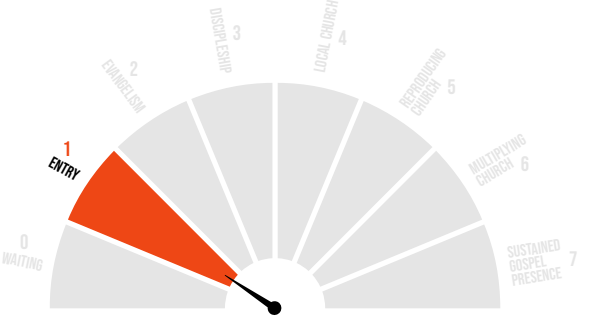
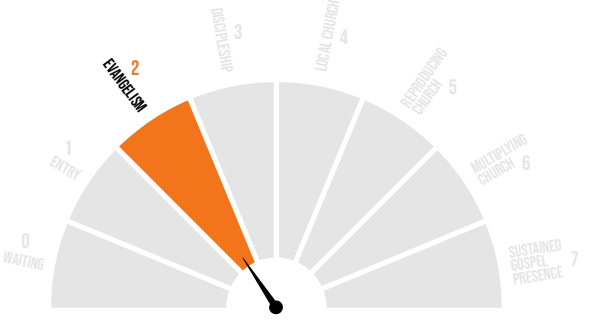
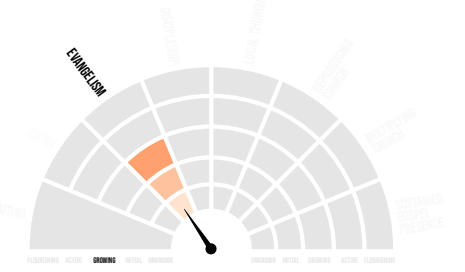


Workers or near-culture believers gain access to the people group and begin laying relational foundations to share Christ and plant churches. The focus is on connecting, learning, and building bridges.

PHASE 2 - EVANGELISM





Regular, culturally relevant gospel engagement is taking place, with the intention of planting self-sustaining churches.

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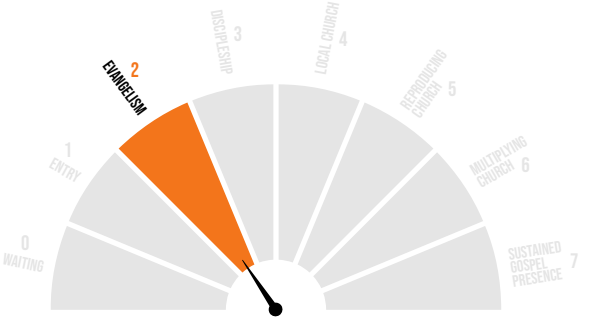
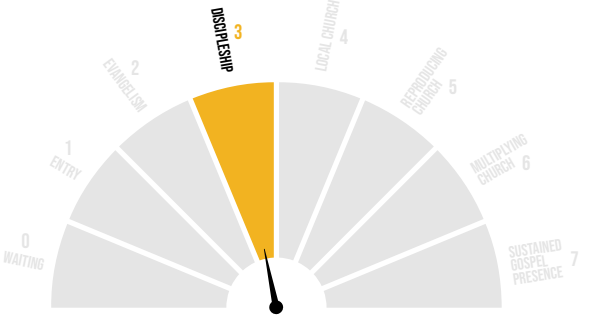
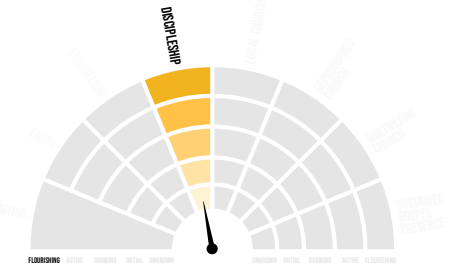


Regular, culturally relevant gospel engagement is taking place, with the intention of planting self-sustaining churches.

PHASE 3 - DISCIPLESHIP





Individuals or small clusters respond in repentance and faith. Early discipleship stresses obedience to Scripture, laying foundations for self-sustaining churches consistent with evangelical faith and practice.

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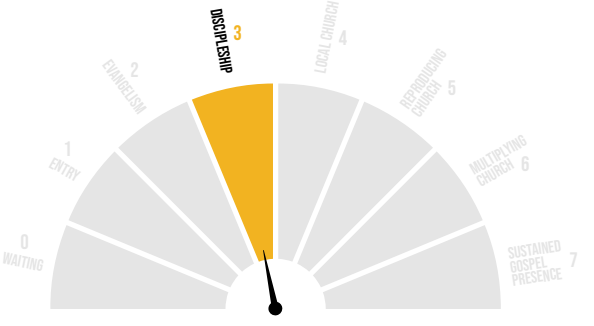

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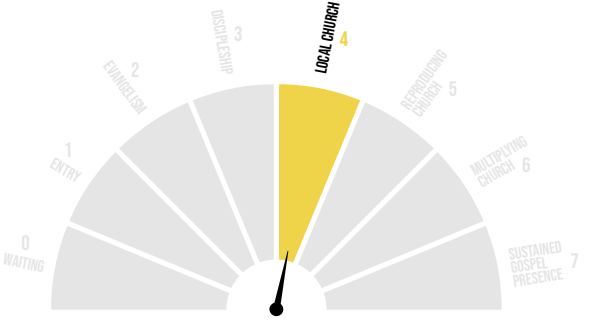
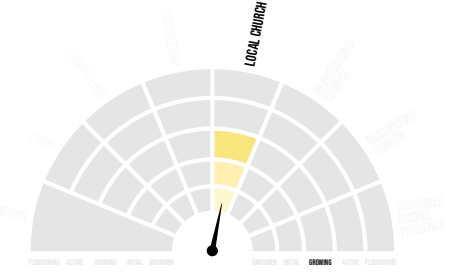
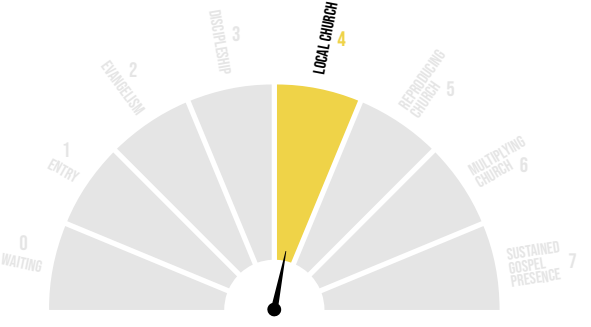
PHASE 4 - LOCAL CHURCH





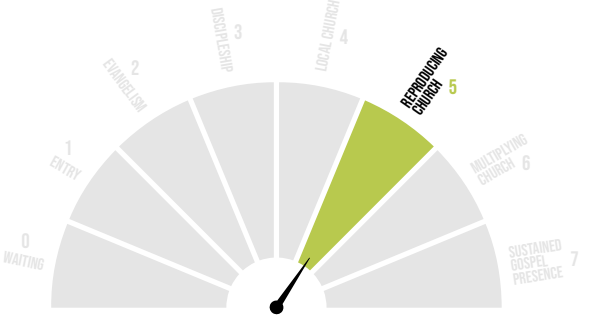
Believers from the people group gather regularly, functioning as a local church that is consistent with evangelical faith and practice. Leaders from the people group are emerging among these churches.

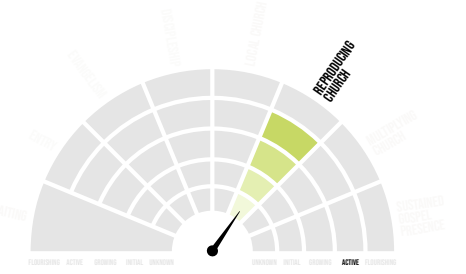
PHASE 4 - LOCAL CHURCH



Believers from the people group gather regularly, functioning as a local church that is consistent with evangelical faith and practice. Leaders from the people group are emerging among these churches.

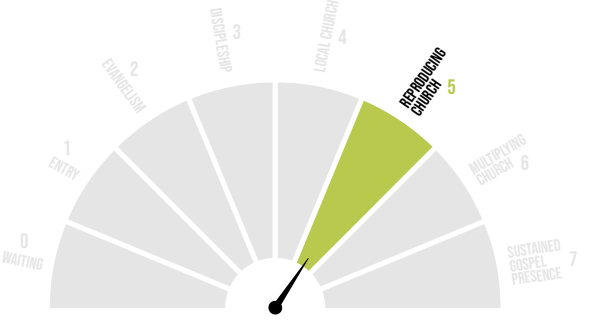
PHASE 5 - REPRODUCING CHURCH





Churches from the people group are sending out evangelists or church planters to plant new churches among their own people. Second-generation groups and churches are forming.

PHASE 5 - REPRODUCING CHURCH



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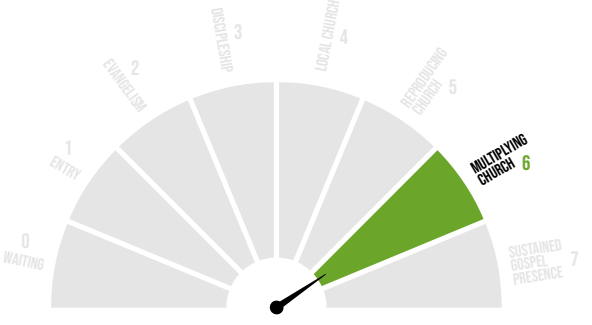
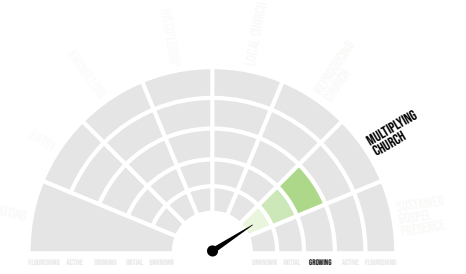
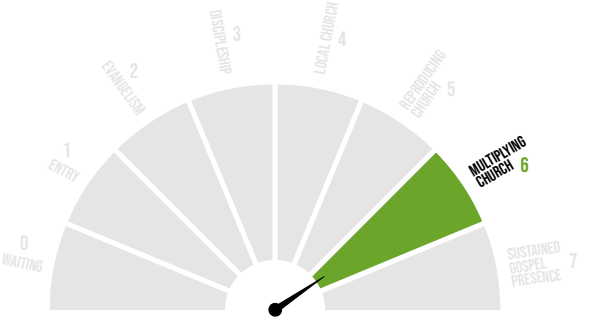
PHASE 6 - MULTIPLYING CHURCH





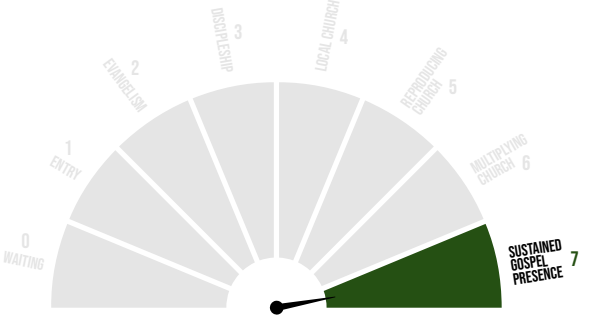
Generational church streams spread across the people group, reaching 4th generation or beyond of both churches and leaders. Church network structures empower local oversight.

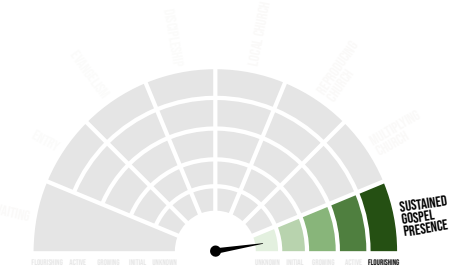
PHASE 6 - MULTIPLYING CHURCH



Generational church streams spread across the people group, reaching 4th generation or beyond of both churches and leaders. Church network structures empower local oversight.

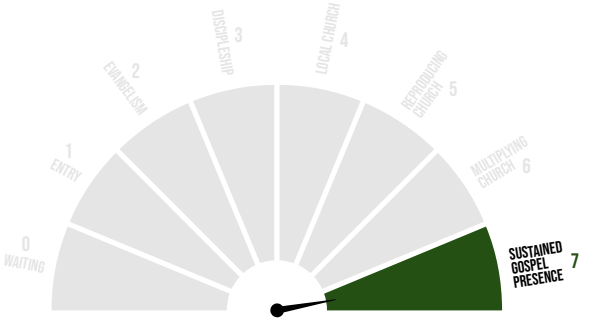
PHASE 7 - SUSTAINED GOSPEL PRESENCE





The people group has either: (1) 10% or more following Christ and worshipping in churches, or (2) several multiplying church planting networks led by believers from the people group, who are sending workers to other people groups while continuing to mature at home.

PHASE 7 - SUSTAINED GOSPEL PRESENCE



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